



FROM OUR ARCHIVES: DILIP DOSHI
ON INDIA'S VICTORY OVER
ENGLAND AT THE WANKHEDE
STADIUM IN 1981

Our last call: Remembering Dilip *da*

Remembering Dilip Doshi: left-arm spinner, sharp mind, **generous mentor.** A reflection on the man behind the numbers.

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A familiar voice greeted me when I answered the phone on a Saturday evening. It was raining heavily in Mumbai, and the person on the other end said, "Oh, I can hear the sound of the rain... Hope things are fine there."

Having lived in Mumbai for years, he knew how annoying the rains could be. But as we spoke over the next 20-odd minutes, Dilip Doshi said the sound of

the rain made him realise how much he missed the Mumbai monsoon. I had come to refer to him as Dilip *da* — a name that seemed to suit his mix of wisdom, grace, and understated authority.

Calling from his home in London, he was watching India's first Test against England in Leeds. During the lunch break, he suddenly decided to ring me.

"I'm quite impressed with the way Shubman (Gill) and (Rishabh) Pant batted," he said, lauding the centurions.

"This might be a young

team, but it has enough firepower..."

A former India left-arm spinner, Doshi claimed 114 Test wickets in 33 appearances, including six five-wicket hauls. He represented Bengal and Saurashtra domestically and played County cricket for Warwickshire and Nottinghamshire — an experience that, he often said, shaped his understanding of modern-day cricket.

Knowing the Leeds conditions well, Doshi expected India to dominate — if the weather held up. He hoped to attend the third Test at Lord's from July 10. "It should be a highly competitive series. If you're here, we'll watch it together," he said.

Little did we know that it would be our last conversation.

On June 23, Doshi passed away at 77, following a cardiac arrest — leaving behind a rich legacy and a lifetime of memories. A true gentleman, he never hesitated to talk cricket. If a young player reached out, he made time, always eager to guide.

That was him.

Despite debuting in Tests at 32 and often finding himself in and out of the squad, Doshi proved his mettle.

Teammates remember him as a "thinking man's

VIJAY SONEJI

